VISMA TECH LITHUANIA · COACH DAY

AI: *Expectations* vs. *Reality*.

A working session for coaches on what AI is actually doing to our teams — the good, the broken, and the conversations we've been avoiding.

~2H 30MIN GROUPS OF 3–4 6 CASES

RUN OF SHOW

What we'll do *today*.

01	Everyone's voice on the wall	15 MIN
02	Survey themes + tensions	15 MIN
03	Break	10 MIN
04	Case work in groups	50 MIN
05	Presentations, back to green, closing	50 MIN

PHASE 01 · 15 MIN

01

Everyone's voice on the *wall*.

Before anyone hears about the survey, the whole room speaks. Otherwise half of you are spectators in a workshop framed by someone else's answers.

YOUR TURN · 15 MIN

Two sticky notes. No discussion.

GREEN

One thing that genuinely got better with AI in your team.

RED

One thing that got harder, broke, or worries you.

Write, walk to the wall, stick. Don't explain. Don't cluster — the room will see its own patterns.

WHAT THE SURVEY SAID

9 coaches also answered in advance.

Four open questions. Honest answers. Their patterns and yours on the wall tell the same story from two angles — here's what came back from the survey.

THEME 01 · CODE REVIEW CRISIS

7/9

RESPONDENTS

The senior became a *proofreader*.

AI generates huge PRs — 100+ files. Review takes hours. Quality is uncertain. The fun of coding went to the machine; humans got the leftovers.

> *"I used to build things. Now I check if a machine built them correctly."*
>
> PARAPHRASED FROM SURVEY

THEME 02 · BOTTLENECK MIGRATION

5/9

RESPONDENTS

Coding got fast. Nothing else *did*.

Requirements gathering, testing, release — untouched. Teams finish code faster but don't ship more. QA is drowning. The bottleneck didn't disappear; it moved.

THEME 03 · EXISTENTIAL MOTIVATION CRISIS

5/9

RESPONDENTS

"What's the *point* of me?"

Developers losing meaning. Backlogs emptying. Some considering leaving. The range is wide — total AI refusal on one end, thriving on the other. Most are somewhere uncertain in between.

THEME 04 · PUSHBACK AGAINST PRESSURE

5/9

RESPONDENTS

"Why are we being *forced*?"

Unclear why Visma Tech is pushing AI so hard. Is it to be first? Because the CTO said so? To avoid layoffs? Silence breeds worst-case assumptions.

> *"I'd respect any answer. I just want the real one."*
>
> PARAPHRASED FROM SURVEY

THEME 05 · "AI PROGRAMMERS" CONFLICT

4/9

RESPONDENTS

POs and analysts *became developers.*

Non-technical roles using AI to make technical decisions — bypassing architecture, security, and the people responsible for them. A new power struggle, poorly acknowledged.

THEME 06 · COGNITIVE OVERLOAD

3/9

RESPONDENTS

One agent is already *a lot*.

Even managing a single AI agent stretches human capacity. Multiple agents overwhelm. Our brains weren't built to track this much parallel output this fast.

PHASE 02 · 15 MIN

02

Four *tensions*.

Not quotes. Not attribution. The shape of what the survey and the wall are telling us — put in words we can argue with.

TENSION 01

Speed.

EXPECTATION

AI makes us faster.

→

REALITY

The bottleneck moved, not disappeared.

Coding got fast. Requirements, testing, and release didn't keep up.

TENSION 02

The "why".

EXPECTATION

Everyone should use AI.

→

REALITY

Nobody explained why, and pressure feels coercive.

"Is this for us — or for Visma's image?"

TENSION 03

Who builds.

EXPECTATION

AI democratizes building.

→

REALITY

Non-developers making technical decisions creates new conflicts.

POs and managers "became programmers" overnight.

TENSION 04

Meaning.

EXPECTATION

Developers adapt.

→

REALITY

The meaning and joy of the work is under threat.

Some people are quietly updating CVs.

PAUSE

Break.

10 minutes. Coffee. Bathroom. Breathe before the hard part.

PHASE 03 · 50 MIN

03

Case work in *groups*.

Cases instead of abstract topics. You can't be vague about a situation with a person in it. Each group gets one case — no choosing.

CASE A

A

The senior who became a proofreader.

- A senior developer stopped writing code.
- Their days are spent reviewing AI-generated PRs — often 100+ files each.
- A mid-level on the same team is thriving — shipping fast, running agents.
- The senior is quietly updating their CV.

> *"I used to build things. Now I check if a machine built them correctly. I could be anyone."*

REVIEW OVERLOAD | MOTIVATION | TEAM ASYMMETRY

CASE B

B

The PO who became a developer.

- The Product Owner built a working prototype over the weekend with AI.
- Monday: 2,000 lines of generated code, submitted as a PR to the main repo. "Just review and merge it — it works."
- The tech lead pushed back on architecture and security.
- The PO escalated to their manager. Both sides are looking at you.

> *"The development team is blocking innovation and slowing us down."*

ROLE BOUNDARIES | ARCHITECTURE BYPASS | POWER DYNAMICS

CASE C

The team that ran out of work.

- Throughput tripled. A 6-month backlog is nearly empty at month 2.
- The partner is delighted but hasn't prepared more requirements.
- Two people asked you privately: *"Will they still need all of us?"* You don't have an honest answer.
- A third stopped using AI entirely — "why would I help make myself redundant faster?"

BOTTLENECK SHIFT | EXISTENTIAL FEAR | SELF-SABOTAGE

CASE D

D

The silent room.

- In a retrospective, a developer says out loud what many have been thinking: nobody has explained *why* the team is being pushed to adopt AI.
- They ask directly: is this about impressing Visma? About headcount cuts? They say they'd respect any honest answer.
- The room goes silent. Everyone turns to you — the coach.
- You can't pass this one up the chain in the moment. You also don't actually know the real "why" yourself.

> *"I'd respect any answer — I just want the real one."*

MISSING "WHY" | LEADERSHIP GAP | COACH'S UNCERTAINTY

CASE E

E

The bug that slipped through.

- Dev throughput doubled. QA capacity didn't.
- A client found a security vulnerability in AI-generated code that passed review.
- The reviewer admitted they didn't fully understand that section — but "it looked clean."
- Team lead wants to slow down. The partner wants to speed up. Trust is shaken on both sides.

> *"We're not actually going faster. We're finding out about problems later."*

QUALITY VS SPEED | FALSE CONFIDENCE | TRUST EROSION

CASE F

The success stories that won't stop.

- Your team is doing fine. Delivery is steady, quality is holding, people are learning AI tools at a healthy pace.
- But managers — yours and the partner's — keep hearing polished AI success stories: internal demos, LinkedIn posts, conference talks, "team X shipped in a weekend."
- Every week you get the same question, in new words: *"Why aren't we building like that?"*
- You know most of those stories are survivorship-biased, cherry-picked, or quietly unfinished. But that's a hard argument to win against a highlight reel.
- Your team is starting to feel the pressure. Some are cutting corners to "look faster." Others are disengaging.

BENCHMARK PRESSURE | SURVIVORSHIP BIAS | PROTECTING THE TEAM

BEFORE YOU START

Five minutes of *silence*.

Read your case alone before anyone talks. The loudest voice in the group shouldn't anchor the diagnosis. Then — two tasks.

PICK A WRITER

One person fills in the worksheet as the group works — not at the end. The worksheet is the artifact; leadership will read it. Make it legible.

CASE D — ONE THING BEFORE WE START

Case D is about leadership not explaining the "why." I am leadership. If your group gets that case, speak freely. I'd rather hear it here than not hear it at all.

Peel back the *layers*.

Use "why?" at least three times. Don't stop at the first answer.

1 **Surface**

What's visible? What would a manager see from the outside?

2 **Underneath**

What's driving it? What systemic or organizational factors created this?

3 **Core**

What's the real fear or need? What is this person actually afraid of losing?

FORCING FUNCTION

If you're writing process problems in the "core" column, you haven't gone deep enough. The core is always about people — identity, safety, meaning, control.

Stop. Start. *Escalate*.

What changes — in behavior, in structure, and in the actual words you'd say on Monday.

Stop

What are we currently doing that makes this problem worse?

Start

What should we begin doing? Action points — practices, rituals, guardrails, experiments. **One of these must be the actual conversation** you'd have with the person in the case: full sentences, your own words, plus what you would NOT say.

Escalate

What can't we fix at the coach level? Who specifically needs to act — and by when?

FORCING FUNCTIONS

The conversation must only make sense for THIS case — if it works for any case, it's too generic. "Escalate" needs a name and a date — not "leadership should communicate better," but "we bring this to [name] by [date]."

PHASE 04 · 50 MIN

04

Present.
Come back to *green*.
Follow through.

Each group shares only three things. Task 1 stays on the worksheet — it was work done for the group, not the room.

PRESENTATION FORMAT · ~5 MIN PER GROUP

Three things. That's it.

1 **The core — one sentence**

What is the person in this case actually afraid of losing?

2 **Start — read the actual words aloud**

The opening of the conversation you'd have on Monday.

3 **One Escalate item**

With a name and a date.

AFTER EACH GROUP

1–2 minutes open floor — reactions, challenges, additions. Two groups on the same case present back-to-back so the contrast is visible.

BEFORE WE CLOSE · 10 MIN

Back to the *green*.

We spent an hour on the hard parts. Now walk back to the sticky wall. Read the green notes. What's actually working? What should we keep doing — and spread?

GREEN

The things that got better. Name them out loud. Name who made them better.

GREEN

Pick one to steal. Which green note — not yours — are you taking back to your team?